

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY
U.G. Semester-II Examination 2024-25 (NEP)

ECONOMICS

Paper Code: ECOMD21 : Indian Economic Development

Time: 2:30 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

(Write your Roll No. at the top immediately on the receipt of this question paper)

Note: The question paper carries three Sections: A, B, and C. All questions are compulsory. The figures in the right-hand margin indicate marks.

SECTION A

Note: Write your answer in about 50 words. Each question carries 2 marks. [10 × 2 = 20 Marks]

1. Answer all of the following:

- (i) Write two major policy failures that contributed to the 1991 economic crisis. [2]
- (ii) What do you understand by the term “Balance of Payments Crisis”? [2]
- (iii) Write two key structural differences between the Planning Commission and NITI Aayog. [2]
- (iv) What are the major types of unemployment in India? [2]
- (v) What is meant by the Right to Work? [2]
- (vi) Write two indicators used to assess social sector development. [2]
- (vii) Define the Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS). [2]
- (viii) Write two major problems in the functioning of the PDS in India. [2]
- (ix) Write two examples of social safety net programmes in India. [2]
- (x) Write about two major industries adversely affected during British rule in India. [2]

SECTION B

Note: Write your answer in about 250 words. Each question carries 5 marks. [4 × 5 = 20 Marks]

- 2. What was the main objective of India’s First Five-Year Plan? [5]**

OR

Discuss the implications of a service-led growth model for inclusive development and employment in India. [5]

3. What were the main causes of the 1991 Balance of Payments crisis in India? Explain how it led to a shift in economic policy. [5]

OR

Evaluate the performance of Indian agriculture in terms of productivity and growth during the Green Revolution period. [5]

4. What are the major criticisms of the Planning Commission that led to the formation of NITI Aayog? [5]

OR

Despite high growth in the services sector, employment generation remains a concern. Critically analyse this paradox. [5]

5. Critically examine the effectiveness of the Public Distribution System in ensuring food security in India. [5]

OR

Discuss the structural distortions in the Indian economy caused by British colonial rule. How did they affect India's post-independence planning priorities? [5]

SECTION C

Note: Answer all questions. Each question carries 10 marks. [3 × 10 = 30 Marks]

6. Critically evaluate the shift from the Planning Commission to NITI Aayog. Has it improved India's development planning process? [10]

OR

The Indian economy has seen a rapid rise in services without a strong industrial base. Is this sustainable? Justify your answer. [10]

7. Critically analyse the impact of MGNREGA on rural livelihoods and poverty alleviation. Has it lived up to its legal mandate of employment guarantee? [10]

OR

Critically assess the relevance and limitations of the Nehru-Mahalanobis model in shaping India's early economic development. [10]

8. Discuss the changing trends in unemployment in India, especially among the youth and educated population. What structural issues underlie this problem? [10]

OR

Discuss the interlinkages between agriculture, industry, and services in India. How has the lack of balanced growth affected overall development? [10]